

Parts of Speech

In Arabic, a single word is referred to a **كَلِمَةٌ** (Plural: **كَلِمَاتٌ**). Every word in the Arabic language – whether written, spoken or read – falls into 1 of 3 exclusive categories:

1. **اِسْمٌ** - A noun
2. **فِعْلٌ** - A verb
3. **حَرْفٌ** - A particle

Book 1 concentrates heavily on **اَلْاِسْمُ**. This is because nouns comprise approximately 60% to 70% of the Arabic language.

Key Properties of **اِسْمٌ**

It is essential to understand that every Arabic noun possesses inherent properties regarding its gender and number.

Gender (**جِنْسٌ**)

In Arabic, every noun is assigned a gender. There are no neutral nouns; even inanimate objects and abstract concepts are categorised as either:

1. **مَذَكَّرٌ** - Masculine
2. **مُؤَنَّثٌ** - Feminine

Example	Meaning	Gender
كُرْسِيٌّ	A chair	مَذَكَّرٌ
سَيَّارَةٌ	A car	مُؤَنَّثٌ
صَبْرٌ	Patience	مَذَكَّرٌ

Number (عَدَدٌ)

Arabic nouns are further categorised by the quantity they represent.

Unlike English, which distinguishes only between singular and plural,

Arabic identifies 3 distinct states:

1. مُفْرَدٌ - Singular:
 - Refers to the singular (1) – كُرْسِيٌّ
2. مَثْنِيٌّ - Dual:
 - Refers to the dual (2) – كُرْسِيَّانِ
3. جَمْعٌ - Plural:
 - Refers to the plural (3+) - كُرَاسِيٌّ

الدَّرْسُ الْأَوَّلُ (هَذَا)

The 1st concept introduced is هذا. Grammatically, it is classified as اِسْمُ الْإِشَارَةِ (a noun of pointing or a demonstrative pronoun) and means “this”.

Spelling and Pronunciation Rules

There is a specific orthographic rule regarding **هذا** that differs from its phonetics. When pronouncing the 1st letter **هـ**, it must be stretched for two counts. So it will be pronounced as **ها**. However, the alif is not written in standard Arabic script.

The Three Strict Conditions for Usage

هذا can only be used to point to an object if it meets 3 specific criteria:

1. **مَفْرَدٌ** - The object must be singular
2. **مَذَكَّرٌ** - The object must be masculine
3. **قَرِيبٌ** - The object must be in close proximity

Absence of the Copular

There is no “is” or “are”. When a sentence like **هَذَا بَيْتٌ** is written, the literal translation is “This [a] house”. To provide a grammatically correct translation, the words “is” or “are” is automatically implied. “This [is] a house”.

Vocabulary

كَلِمَةٌ	English	جِنْسٌ	عَدَدٌ
بَيْتٌ	[a] house	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ
مَسْجِدٌ	[a] house	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ
بَابٌ	[a] door	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ
كِتَابٌ	[a] book	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ
قَلَمٌ	[a] pen	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ
مِفْتَاحٌ	[a] key	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ
مَكْتَبٌ	[a] desk	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ
سَرِيرٌ	[a] bed	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ
كُرْسِيٌّ	[a] chair	مَذَكَّرٌ	مَفْرَدٌ





هَذَا كُرْسِيٌّ

هَذَا سَرِيرٌ

هَذَا مَكْتَبٌ